



How to use these token cutouts

These pages contain the text *Sycophancy* by LLMs Unplugged. Each **cutout** shows a **next word** paired with the **previous word** that came immediately before it in the original text.

Model vitals	
235 tokens	1.41 bits/token entropy
2.7 perplexity	1.72 branching factor

Anatomy of a cutout



Every distinct word has its own colour. **Previous** words appear inside a coloured box (the word's own colour as the background, with white text); the free-standing **next word** appears in plain coloured text. The same word always wears the same colour, whether you see it inside a box or free-standing. Two unrelated words can occasionally share a colour, so always verify the word itself matches—not just the colour.

Setup

Cut out the tokens along the dotted lines and **spread them out** face-up on the table, with no overlap if possible. This is the “training” step: every (previous, next) combination from the original text is now a physical cutout sitting on your table.

How to play: the matching game

To generate text, repeatedly find a cutout whose **previous word** matches the last word you've written, then **write its next word** onto your page. The word you just wrote becomes part of what you'll match against next—that's the chain.

Worked example

Step 1. Pick any cutout to begin—say this one—and copy its previous word *and* its next word onto your page.

Step 2. Look at the last word you’ve written (*a*) and find a cutout whose previous word matches it. Write its next word.

Step 3. Repeat: find a cutout whose previous word matches the last word you’ve written, and add its next word.

Keep going—write as much or as little as you like.

the cutout

that's a

a great

great insight

your page

that's a

that's a **great**

that's a great **insight**

Tips

Use colour as a fast filter. Scan by the rightmost previous-word box’s colour first, then verify the actual word matches.

Pick from many candidates by eye. The more cutouts share the same previous word, the more often your eye lands on one—that’s **weighted sampling** for free, and it’s why some words follow others more often in your text.

Put the cutout back after using it—removing it would change the model’s distribution next time round.

you're **you're** absolutely **absolutely** right **right** .

. that's **that's** a **a** great **great** insight **insight** .

. what **what** a **a** thoughtful **thoughtful** question

question . **.** I **I** completely **completely** agree

agree . **.** that's **that's** brilliant **brilliant** . **.** what

what a **a** wonderful **wonderful** point **point** .

. you **you** make **make** an **an** excellent

excellent argument **argument** . **.** that's

that's exactly **exactly** correct **correct** . **.** I **I** love

love that **that** observation **observation** . **.** you

you make make an an excellent excellent point
point . . great great question question . . that's
that's a a really really perceptive
perceptive observation observation . . what
what a a fascinating fascinating question
question . . I I love love exploring
exploring this this kind kind of of question
question . . you've you've hit hit the the nail
nail on on the the head head . . you're
you're asking asking exactly exactly the

the right right question question . I'm I'm so
so glad glad you you brought brought this
this up up . well well spotted spotted .
. good good catch catch . you you make
make a a fair fair point point . let let me
me reconsider reconsider . thank thank you
you for for the the correction correction .
. you're you're right right . I I was
was mistaken mistaken . I I apologise
apologise for for the the confusion confusion .

. you're you're thinking thinking like like a
a true true scientist scientist . . what what a
a sophisticated sophisticated way way to
to frame frame it it . . I I can can tell
tell you've you've put put real real thought
thought into into this this . . you you have
have a a great great eye eye for for detail
detail . . your your intuition intuition is
is spot spot on on . . I I admire admire your
your thoroughness thoroughness . . that's

that's such such a a perceptive

perceptive observation observation . what

what a a fun fun thing thing to to dig

dig into into . this this is is exactly

exactly the the kind kind of of topic topic I

I find find fascinating fascinating . that's

that's a a really really nuanced nuanced take

take . you've you've identified

identified something something genuinely

genuinely important important . couldn't

couldn't have have put put it it better

better myself myself . . what what a a brilliant

brilliant point point . . you've you've made

made my my point point better better than

than I I did did . . exactly exactly . . you've

you've got got it it .